WEDE5020
WEB DEVELOPMENT

WEBSITE PROPOSAL

Part 1 – Building the Foundation

+ Part 3 Enhancements

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1. Organisation Overview

Name: Luxury Designs

Brief history of the organisation

Luxury Designs is an online retail store specialising in premium fashion items including designer-inspired clothing, handbags, jewellery and accessories. The idea behind the store is simple: to give people access to stylish, high-quality fashion without needing to visit a physical shop.

Mission

To offer customers a smooth, high-end online shopping experience built on quality and style.

Vision

To become one of South Africa's go-to online stores for affordable luxury fashion.

Target Audience

Fashion-conscious men and women aged 20–45 who enjoy shopping online and want to look good without paying full designer prices.

2. Website Goals and Objectives

The primary goal is to create an attractive, conversion-focused website that drives online enquiries for products.

Main goals

- Grow online sales
- Build a strong, trustworthy brand image
- Make it easy for customers to browse and enquire about products
- Build brand credibility and support the transition to a physical retail location

Objectives

- Display products clearly with images, names and prices
- Provide an easy-to-use navigation menu (Home, About, Products, Enquiry, Contact)
- Show warehouse location and contact details for customer convenience
- Use a clean professional design that reflects quality and style

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- Number of product enquiry form submissions per month
- Organic website traffic from Google searches (tracked via Google Analytics)
- Bounce rate (target low, indicating engaging content)

3. Current Website Analysis

Luxury Designs has been developed by learning from successful online fashion stores and avoiding common mistakes such as messy layouts, slow-loading pages, or confusing navigation.

The website has a solid foundation with all the required sections (Home, About, Products, Enquiry and Contact). It successfully covers the main goals of showcasing products and allowing customer enquiries. With the Part 3 interactive features, improved visual design and detailed product content, the website

better reflects the “affordable luxury” brand.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Core Pages

Homepage — Eye-catching hero banner, featured products, short brand intro and clear calls-to-action.

About Us — Brand story, mission and vision presented in tabbed sections, plus warehouse location.

Products — Items displayed in a responsive grid with photo, name, price and category. Live search and category filter.

FAQ — Accordion-style frequently asked questions covering shipping, returns, quality and tracking.

Enquiry — Product-specific form so customers can ask about availability, size, colour or pricing.

Contact — General contact form with name, email, phone, subject and full message.

Responsive Design

- **Desktop** (above 900px): Full multi-column layout
- **Tablet** (900px and below): 2-column product grid, adjusted spacing
- **Mobile** (600px and below): Single-column product grid, hamburger menu

5. Part 3 Enhancements – Functionality, SEO & Forms

Part 3 of the project focused on enhancing functionality with JavaScript, applying SEO best practices, implementing robust form validation, and preparing the site for deployment.

5.1 Interactive Elements (JavaScript)

- Lightbox gallery – clicking a product opens a large image view with caption; closes on background click or close button.
- Tabs – About section uses tabs for Story, Mission & Vision, and Location & Map.
- Accordion – FAQ section expands/collapses answers smoothly.
- Mobile menu – hamburger toggle for navigation on smaller screens.
- Scroll animations – fade-in effects as content enters the viewport.
- Live product search and category filter – products filter instantly as the user types or selects a category.

5.2 Dynamic Content

All products are stored in a JavaScript array and rendered dynamically into the product grid. This allows easy future expansion of the catalogue and supports the live search/filter feature.

5.3 Interactive Map

A Google Maps embed shows the Johannesburg warehouse location under the About → Location & Map tab. This provides a reliable location-based feature without tile-blocking issues.

5.4 Forms & Validation

Product Enquiry form – Collects full name, email, product of interest (dropdown) and message. JavaScript validates each field (name length, email format, required product, minimum message length) and displays clear error messages. On success a confirmation message is shown with next steps.

General Contact form – Collects name, email, optional SA phone number, message type and full message. Validation includes phone-number format checks. On success the form shows a compiled “email-style” summary (To / From / Subject) simulating the processing that would occur with a real email or Formspree/Netlify Forms integration.

5.5 SEO Best Practices

- Descriptive page title and meta description optimised for “affordable luxury fashion South Africa”.
- Relevant meta keywords.
- Open Graph tags for social sharing.
- Semantic heading structure (H1–H3).
- Descriptive image alt text and title attributes on every product image.
- Clean internal linking via the navigation and footer.
- Mobile-friendly responsive layout.

6. Design and User Experience

- **Colours** — Black, gold and off-white to create an elegant, premium feel.
- **Fonts** — Playfair Display (serif) for headings; Inter (sans-serif) for body text.
- **Layout** — Simple, image-heavy design with open space so products stand out.
- **User experience** — Easy-to-use menu, mobile-friendly design, clear calls-to-action guiding users to shop or enquire.

7. Technical Requirements

- **Languages** — HTML5, CSS3 and vanilla JavaScript for all interactive features.
- **Domain** — www.luxurydesigns.co.za (estimated R150–R300 per year).
- **Hosting** — GitHub Pages or Netlify (free tier suitable for student submissions); Afrihost for a paid production option.

8. Timeline and Milestones

Stage	Timeframe
Research and planning	Week 1–2
Sitemap & layout sketches	Week 3
Building the HTML structure	Week 3–4
Styling and navigation	Week 5–6
Part 3: JavaScript, forms, SEO, map	Week 6–7
Testing and fixing issues	Week 7
Final submission	Week 8

9. Budget

Estimated real-world costs for a live deployment:

- Domain name: R150 – R300 per year (domains.co.za)
- Hosting: R0 via GitHub Pages / Netlify; Afrihost approximately R200–R300 monthly for a business site
- Product photography: approximately R2,000 for professional images
- Development: R0 (student project)

10. Changelog – Part 3 Updates

The following changes were implemented for Part 3 (Enhancing Functionality and SEO):

- Implemented full JavaScript interactivity: accordion (FAQ), tabs (About), lightbox gallery, mobile menu toggle.
- Added dynamic product loading from a JavaScript array so the product catalogue can be updated without rewriting HTML.
- Built live search and category filter for the product grid.
- Created two distinct forms (Product Enquiry and General Contact) with complete client-side validation and clear error messages.
- Added success feedback that confirms processing and next steps to the user (simulated AJAX-style response).
- Embedded a Google Maps location for the Johannesburg warehouse under the About section.
- Strengthened on-page SEO: title tag, meta description, keywords, Open Graph tags, semantic headings, descriptive image alt text.
- Added scroll-triggered fade-in animations for a smoother user experience.
- Ensured the entire site remains fully responsive across desktop, tablet and mobile breakpoints.

11. References

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